General Bipin Rawat and Army Chief M.M. Naravane landed at the Kushok Bakula Rimpochee airport at Leh and made his way after to a forward post in Nimu, Ladakh, at 11,000 feet.[7] The prime minister spoke to senior military personnel who briefed him on the Galwan clash along with activities at other points of tension. He then proceeded to visit the wounded soldiers, followed by a speech to uplift their spirits. A prime minister being present at a point of conflict hadn't happened in India's recent past, and not only did it boost the morale of the Armed Forces but also sent a tough message to the global community that India would not accept this expansionist attitude and would fight tooth and nail to defend its territory. His visit was also significant because at a time when most world leaders weren't travelling, the prime minister not only went to a forward base in Ladakh for the sake of the Armed Forces, even when his NSA was in isolation, but had also done so in the aftermath of Cyclone Amphan in West Bengal and Odisha a month ago.[8]

Following the visit, the Indian government was firm on its view that border tensions and bilateral relations would have to go hand in hand. Border tensions and clashes would not be looked at as stand-alone events with no effect on bilateral relations.[9] In a bid to display this line of thought, over the next couple of months, the Indian government took strategic policy decisions like banning several Chinese apps in circulation in India and also mandating disclosure of source of funds and prior government approval for foreign direct investments (FDIs) from border nations in various strategic sectors of business. While, on ground, the trade impact from that would not be major, the message that it sent out globally was strong, especially during a time when the world was holding China accountable for the spread of the pandemic and its irresponsible delay in alerting the WHO. In a post-COVID world, a supply chain rejig would likely follow India's stance on cutting down over-reliant trade relationships with China. In a situation where global supply chains would be recalibrated, India, empowered with the new atmanirbhar policies and a powerful labour force, would appear to be a rather attractive destination conducive for global business interests. To reiterate, in a recent comment in *The Australian*, former Australian Prime Minister Tony Abbott, noted, 'The answer to almost every question about China is India. With the world's other emerging superpowers becoming more belligerent almost by the day, it's in everyone's interests that India take its rightful place among the nations as quickly as possible.'[10]